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C. Idioms

Look at the list of idioms given below. Find their meanings from a dictionary. Read the sentences that follow and replace the words in italics with the appropriate idioms, making suitable changes wherever necessary.

- right up one's alley -
- drive one up the wall –
- hit the road –
- take (one) for a ride –
- in panic mode –

a) The old man *got irritated* at the loud noise outside.

b) We were driving, when it started raining heavily. After stopping for an hour, we *began the journey again*.

c) Ramesh gave false excuses for not attending the meeting and *deceived me*.

d) At the interview when questions were fired at me rapidly, I *forgot everything and grew irritated*.

e) I love thrillers and this book *appeals to me strongly*.

Listening Activity

Listen to the dialogue read out by the teacher or to the recorded version and answer the questions that follow:

i) _____was one of the places visited by Mahesh.

a) Srilanka b) Goa
c) Kasi d) Cochin

ii) The Art Museum at Trivandrum is called_____.

a) Swarnalayam b) Gitalayam
c) Chitralayam d) Saranalayam

iii) Varkala is the oldest port of_____.

a) Quilon b) Andhra
c) Puducherry d) the Andamans

iv) Mahesh had been to the _____ Lake Wild Life Sanctuary.

a) Chidambaram b) Pulicat
c) Kovalam d) Periyar

v) Cochin is called the _____ of the East.

a) Granary b) Cuba
c) Venice d) Pearl

Speaking Activity

a) Build a dialogue of 8–10 exchanges between your friend and yourself, on the following situation:

You were to board a train to Delhi. By mistake you got into the wrong train and fought for your seat there. On realising your mistake, you left the train shamefaced, after creating a commotion there. Role-play this situation before the class.

b) Speak to the class for a minute, as to how one should conduct oneself on formal occasions. (You could talk about table-manners especially while eating, general appearance, manner of speaking, etc.)